Specification of the protected designation of origin "POUILLY-LOCHÉ"

approved by decree no. 2011-1798 of 6 December 2011, JORF of 8 December 2011

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the protected designation of origin "Pouilly-Loché", initially recognised by the decree of 27 April 1940.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

1. The name of the protected designation of origin may be supplemented by the term "premier cru" for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for this term in the present specification.

2. The name of the protected designation of origin may be supplemented by the term "premier cru" and followed by the name of the climat below, for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for this term in the present specification.

3. The name of the protected designation of origin may be followed by the name of the climat "les Mûres" for wines meeting the production conditions laid down for the term "premier cru" in the present specification.

III. – Colour and types of product

The protected designation of origin "Pouilly-Loché" is reserved for still white wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the commune of Mâcon in the Saône-et-Loire department, on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2023.

The cartographic documents representing the geographical area may be consulted on the website of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

2° – Delimited parcel area

a) The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at its session of 23 November 2016. The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town hall of the commune referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

b) Wines eligible for the term "premier cru" come from grapes from parcels situated within the specific delimited parcel production area as approved by the competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of 6 February 2024. The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town hall of the commune referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes, on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2023:

- Côte-d'Or department: Agencourt, Aloxe-Corton, Ancey, Arcenant, Argilly, Autricourt, Auxey-Duresses, Baubigny, Beaune, Belan-sur-Ource, Bévy, Bissey-la-Côte, Bligny-lès-Beaune, Boncourt-le-Bois, Bouix, Bouze-lès-Beaune, Brion-sur-Ource, Brochon, Cérilly, Chambœuf, Chambolle-Musigny, Channay, Charrey-sur-Seine, Chassagne-Montrachet, Châtillon-sur-Seine, Chaumont-le-Bois, Chaux, Chenôve, Chevannes, Chorey-lès-Beaune, Collonges-lès-Bévy, Combertault, Comblanchien, Corcelles-les-Arts, Corcelles-les-Monts, Corgoloin, Cormot-Vauchignon, Corpeau, Couchey, Curley, Curtil-Vergy, Daix, Dijon, Ebaty, Echevronne, Epernay-sous-Gevrey, Etrochey, Fixin, Flagey-Echézeaux, Flavignerot, Fleurey-sur-Ouche, Fussey, Gerland, Gevrey-Chambertin, Gilly-lès-Cîteaux, Gomméville, Grancey-sur-Ource, Griselles, La-Rochepot, Ladoix-Serrigny, Lantenay, Larrey, L'Etang-Vergy, Levernois, Magny-lès-Villers, Mâlain, Marcenay, Marey-lès-Fussey, Marsannay-la-Côte, Massingy, Mavilly-Mandelot, Meloisey, Merceuil, Messanges, Meuilley, Meursanges, Meursault, Molesme, Montagny-lès-Beaune, Monthelie, Montliot-et-Courcelles, Morey-Saint-Denis, Mosson, Nantoux, Nicey, Noiron-sur-Seine, Nolay, Nuits-Saint-Georges, Obtrée, Pernand-Vergelesses, Perrigny-lès-Dijon, Plombières-lès-Dijon, Poinçon-lès-Larrey, Pommard, Pothières, Premeaux-Prissey, Prusly-sur-Ource, Puligny-Montrachet, Quincey, Reulle-Vergy, Ruffey-lès-Beaune, Saint-Aubin, Saint-Bernard, Sainte-Colombe-sur-Seine, Sainte-Marie-la-Blanche Saint-Philibert, Saint-Romain, Santenay, Savigny-lès-Beaune, Segrois, Tailly, Talant, Thoires, Valforêt (for the part of the territory corresponding to the former commune of Clémencey), Vannaire, Velars-sur-Ouche, Vertault, Vignoles, Villars-Fontaine, Villebichot, Villedieu, Villers-la-Faye, Villers-Patras, Villy-le-Moutier, Vix, Volnay, Vosne-Romanée and Vougeot;

- Rhône department: Alix, Anse, Arnas, Bagnols, Beaujeu, Belleville-en-Beaujolais, Belmont-d'Azergues, Blacé, Bully, Cercié, Chambost-Allières, Chamelet, Charentay, Charnay, Châtillon, Chazay-d'Azergues, Chénas, Chessy, Chiroubles, Cogny, Corcelles-en-Beaujolais, Dareizé, Denicé, Dracé, Emeringes, Fleurie, Frontenas, Gleizé, Juliénas, Jullié, L'Arbresle, Lacenas, Lachassagne, Lancié, Lantignié, Le Breuil, Le Perréon, Légny, Les Ardillats, Létra, Limas, Lozanne, Lucenay, Marchampt, Marcy, Moiré, Montmelas-Saint-Sorlin, Morancé, Odenas, Pommiers, Porte des Pierres Dorées, Quincié-en-Beaujolais, Régnié-Durette, Rivolet, Saint-Etienne-des-Oullières, Saint-Georges-de-Reneins, Saint-Germain-Nuelles, Saint-Vérand, Saint-Clément-sur-Valsonne, Saint-Cyr-le-Chatoux, Saint-Didier-sur-Beaujeu, Sainte-Paule, Saint-Etienne-la-Varenne, Saint-Jean-des-Vignes, Saint-Julien, Saint-Just-d'Avray, Saint-Lager, Saint-Romain-de-Popey, Salles-Arbuissonnas-en-Beaujolais, Sarcey, Taponas, Ternand, Theizé, Val-d'Oingt, Vaux-en-Beaujolais, Vauxrenard, Vernay, Ville-sur-Jarnioux, Villefranche, Villié-Morgon and Vindry-sur-Turdine (for the part of the territory corresponding to the former communes of Dareizé, Les Olmes and Saint-Loup);

- Saône-et-Loire department: Aluze, Ameugny, Azé, Barizey, Beaumont-sur-Grosne, Berzé-la-Ville, Berzé-le-Châtel, Bissey-sous-Cruchaud, Bissy-la-Mâconnaise, Bissy-sous-Uxelles, Bissy-sur-Fley, Blanot, Bonnay-Saint-Ythaire, Bouzeron, Boyer, Bray, Bresse-sur-Grosne, Burgy, Burnand, Bussières, Buxy, Cersot, Chagny, Chaintré, Chalon-sur-Saône, Chamilly, Champagny-sous-Uxelles, Champforgeuil, Chânes, Change, Chapaize, La Chapelle-de-Bragny, La Chapelle-de-Guinchay, La Chapelle-sous-Brancion, Charbonnières, Chardonnay, La Charmée, Charnay-lès-Mâcon, Charrecey, Chasselas, Chassey-le-Camp, Château, Châtenoy-le-Royal, Chaudenay, Cheilly-lès-Maranges, Chenôves, Chevagny-lès-Chevrières, Chissey-lès-Mâcon, Clessé, Cluny, Cormatin, Cortambert, Cortevaix, Couches, Crêches-sur-Saône, Créot, Cruzille, Culles-les-Roches, Curtil-sous-Burnand, Davayé, Demigny, Dennevy, Dezize-lès-Maranges, Donzy-le-Pertuis, Dracy-lès-Couches, Dracy-le-Fort, Epertully, Etrigny, Farges-lès-Chalon, Farges-lès-Mâcon, Flagy, Fleurville, Fley, Fontaines, Fragnes-la-Loyère (for the part of the territory corresponding to the former commune of La Loyère), Fuissé, Genouilly, Germagny, Givry, Granges, Grevilly, Hurigny, Igé, Jalogny, Jambles, Jugy, Jully-lès-Buxy, La Vineuse-sur-Frégande (for the part of the territory corresponding to the former communes of Donzy-le-National, La Vineuse and Massy), Lacrost, Laives, Laizé, Lalheue, Leynes, Lournand, Lugny, Malay, Mancey, Martailly-lès-Brancion, Massilly, Massy, Mellecey, Mercurey, Messey-sur-Grosne, Milly-Lamartine, Montagny-lès-Buxy, Montbellet, Montceaux-Ragny, Moroges, Nanton,

Ozenay, Paris-l'Hôpital, Péronne, Pierreclos, Plottes, Préty, Prissé, Pruzilly, Remigny, La Roche-Vineuse, Romanèche-Thorins, Rosey, Royer, Rully, Saint-Jean-de-Trézy, Saint-Albain, Saint-Ambreuil, Saint-Amour-Bellevue, Saint-Boil, Saint-Clément-sur-Guye, Saint-Denis-de-Vaux, Saint-Désert, Saint-Gengoux-de-Scissé, Saint-Gengoux-le-National, Saint-Germain-lès-Buxy, Saint-Gervais-sur-Couches, Saint-Gilles, Saint-Jean-de-Vaux, Saint-Léger-sur-Dheune, Saint-Mard-de-Vaux, Saint-Martin-Belle-Roche, Saint-Martin-du-Tartre, Saint-Martin-sous-Montaigu, Saint-Maurice-de-Satonnay, Saint-Maurice-des-Champs, Saint-Rémy, Saint-Sernin-du-Plain, Saint-Vallerin, Saint-Vérand, Saisy, La Salle, Salornay-sur-Guye, Sampigny-lès-Maranges, Sancé, Santilly, Sassangy, Saules, Savigny-sur-Grosne, Sennecey-le-Grand, Senozan, Sercy, Serrières, Sigy-le-Châtel, Sologny, Solutré-Pouilly, Saint-Maurice-lès-Couches, Saint-Pierre-de-Varennes, Saint-Symphorien-d'Ancelles, Taizé, Tournus, Uchizy, Varennes-lès-Mâcon, Vaux-en-Pré, Vergisson, Vers, Verzé, Le Villars, Vinzelles and Viré;

- Yonne department: Aigremont, Annay-sur-Serin, Arcy-sur-Cure, Asquins, Augy, Auxerre, Avallon, Bazarnes, Beine, Bernouil, Béru, Bessy-sur-Cure, Bleigny-le-Carreau, Censy, Chablis, Champlay, Champs-sur-Yonne, Chamvres, Charentenay, Châtel-Gérard, Chemilly-sur-Serein, Cheney, Chevannes, Chichée, Chitry, Collan, Coulangeron, Coulanges-la-Vineuse, Courgis, Cruzy-le-Châtel, Dannemoine, Deux-Rivières, Dyé, Epineuil, Escamps, Escolives-Sainte-Camille, Fleys, Fontenay-près-Chablis, Gy-l'Evêque, Héry, Irancy, Island, Joigny, Jouancy, Junay, Jussy, La-Chapelle-Vaupelteigne, Lichères-près-Aigremont, Lignorelles, Ligny-le-Châtel, Lucy-sur-Cure, Maligny, Mélisey, Merry-Sec, Migé, Molay, Molosmes, Montholon (for the part of the territory corresponding to the former communes of Champvallon, Villiers-sur-Tholon and Volgré), Montigny-la-Resle, Mouffy, Moulins-en-Tonnerois, Nitry, Noyers, Ouanne, Paroy-sur-Tholon, Pasilly, Pierre-Perthuis, Poilly-sur-Serein, Pontigny, Préhy, Quenne, Roffey, Rouvray, Saint-Père, Sainte-Pallaye, Sarry, Senan, Serrigny, Saint-Bris-le-Vineux, Saint-Cyr-les-Colons, Sainte-Vertu, Tharoiseau, Tissey, Tonnerre, Tronchoy, Val-de-Mercy, Vallan, Venouse, Venoy, Vermenton, Vézannes, Vézelay, Vézinnes, Villeneuve-Saint-Salves, Villy, Vincelles, Vincelottes, Viviers and Yrouerre.

V. – Grape varieties

The wines come solely from the chardonnay B variety.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density

The vines have a minimum planting density of 8,000 plants per hectare, with a spacing between rows less than or equal to 1.40 metres and a spacing between plants within the same row greater than or equal to 0.80 metre.

b) – Pruning rules

The wines come from vines pruned according to the following provisions:

PRUNING METHOD	**PRUNING RULES**
GENERAL PROVISIONS	
Short pruning (vines trained as Royat cordon)	– The vines are pruned with a maximum of 10 free eyes per plant; – Each plant bears a maximum of 5 spurs, each pruned to a maximum of 2 free eyes.

PRUNING METHOD	**PRUNING RULES**
Long pruning (vines pruned in Guyot or in "taille à queue du Mâconnais")	Vines pruned in single or double Guyot are pruned with a maximum of 10 free eyes per plant. Each plant bears: – either a single cane bearing a maximum of 6 free eyes and 2 spurs each pruned to a maximum of 2 free eyes; – or a single cane bearing a maximum of 8 free eyes and 1 spur pruned to a maximum of 2 free eyes; – or two canes bearing a maximum of 4 free eyes and 1 spur pruned to a maximum of 2 free eyes. Vines pruned in "taille à queue du Mâconnais" are pruned with a maximum of 14 free eyes per plant. Each plant bears a cane with a maximum of 12 free eyes, whose tip is tied to the lower trellising wire.
PARTICULAR PROVISIONS	
When cordons are rejuvenated, the vines are pruned with a maximum of 10 free eyes per plant. Long pruning may be adapted with a 2nd spur allowing the position of the cane to be alternated from one year to the next. Whatever the pruning method, the vines may be pruned with additional free eyes provided that, at the phenological stage corresponding to 11 or 12 leaves, the number of fruit-bearing shoots of the year per plant is less than or equal to the number of free eyes defined in the pruning rules.	

c) – Trellising and foliage height rules

- The vines must be trellised and the trellising is maintained;

- The height of trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, set at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper trimming limit.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set at:

- 10,500 kilograms per hectare for wines eligible for the protected designation of origin "Pouilly-Loché";

- 9,500 kilograms per hectare for wines eligible for the term "premier cru".

e) – Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment, which constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir:

- Permanent grass cover of the headlands is compulsory;

- In parcels producing wines eligible for the term "premier cru", weeding with chemical products is prohibited, including biocontrol products;

- A period of soil rest, or fallow, of at least three growing seasons is compulsory between the grubbing-up and the replanting of a parcel situated within the delimited production area for wines eligible for the term "premier cru";

- Any substantial modification of the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the protected designation of origin is prohibited, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works.

b) – Vine plantings and replacements are carried out with healthy plant material that has undergone hot-water treatment making it possible to combat flavescence dorée.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness.

b) – Particular harvesting provision: wines eligible for the term "premier cru" come from grapes harvested by hand.

c) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest

The harvest is protected from rain during its transport and on its reception.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

The sugar content of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume of the wines meet the following characteristics:

PROTECTED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN	**MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)**	**MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
PDO "Pouilly-Loché"	178	11 %
PDO "Pouilly-Loché" eligible for the term "premier cru"	195	12 %

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1° – Yield and limit yield

The yield and limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code are set at:

PROTECTED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN	**YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)**	**LIMIT YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)**
PDO "Pouilly-Loché"	60	70
PDO "Pouilly-Loché" eligible for the term "premier cru"	58	66

2° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the protected designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any variety other than that permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the variety permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Analytical standards

Finished wines, ready to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, have a maximum fermentable sugar content (glucose + fructose) of:

- 3 grams per litre;

- or 4 grams per litre if the total acidity is greater than or equal to 55.10 milliequivalents per litre, i.e. 4.13 grams per litre expressed as tartaric acid (or 2.7 grams per litre expressed as H2SO4).

b) – Oenological practices and physical treatments

- The use of pieces of wood is prohibited;

- After enrichment, the wines have a total alcoholic strength by volume less than or equal to 13.5 %.

c) – Prohibited equipment

Continuous presses are prohibited.

d) – Vat capacity

Every operator has an overall vat capacity (vinification and storage) equivalent to at least the volume of wine vinified for the previous year’s harvest, as entered either on the harvest declaration, pro rata to the change in the holding’s area in production, or on the production declaration.

e) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar and the vinification equipment are well maintained; this is reflected in particular by:

- general hygiene of the elaboration premises, with general cleanliness, well-maintained floors, adequate drainage and a surface avoiding stagnation;

- harmlessness of the equipment and products coming into contact with the wine;

- separation and specificity of the premises: premises without the same functions must be separated, such as storage areas for plant-protection products, cleaning products or hydrocarbons, from the premises for vinification, ageing and storage of dry goods (corks, cartons);

- management of wine effluents: effluents must be removed as quickly as possible from foodstuff premises and deposited in well-maintained containers that are easy to clean and can be closed; waste storage areas must be kept clean; waste must be disposed of hygienically and in an environmentally friendly manner; a waste storage and removal area must be provided;

- absence of hazardous or odorous substances in the vinification, ageing and storage premises (odour).

f) – Ageing

GENERAL PROVISION	
The temperature of the containers during the ageing phase is controlled and less than or equal to 25 °C.	
PARTICULAR PROVISIONS	
PDO “Pouilly-Loché”	The wines are aged at least until 1 February of the year following that of the harvest.
PDO “Pouilly-Loché” eligible for the term premier cru	The wines are aged at least until 1 July of the year following that of the harvest.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- the reports of analyses carried out before or after packaging.

These analysis reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of a protected storage place for wines packaged in unlabelled bottles, with a temperature of between 5 °C and 22 °C.

4° – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

At the end of the ageing period, the wines are placed on the market for the consumer:

PROTECTED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN	**DATE**
PDO “Pouilly-Loché”	From 15 February of the year following that of the harvest
PDO “Pouilly-Loché” eligible for the term “premier cru”	From 15 July of the year following that of the harvest

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area is situated in the south of the natural region of the “Monts du Mâconnais”, in southern Burgundy. It lies on the east-facing slope of the easternmost ridge of the Mâconnais, facing the Saône plain and the Bresse. It thus extends over the territory of the single commune of Mâcon (former commune of Loché, merged with Mâcon), at the southern end of the Saône-et-Loire department.

This ridge is a relief stretching in a north–south direction. Its eastern slope exposes sedimentary formations of the Secondary era, mainly Lower and Middle Jurassic limestones and marls (clayey limestones) and, at the top of the slope, Triassic sandstones. The soils are relatively varied. Rather acid and beige in colour at the top of the slope, they are clay-limestone and reddish-brown in the middle and lower slope. Shallow soils on hard limestone have developed locally. This variety largely determines the specificity of the various “climats” (names given to cadastral lieux-dits) within the geographical area.

The parcels precisely delimited for the harvesting of the grapes are planted on the east-facing slope, at altitudes of between 210 metres and 280 metres. They overlook the village of Loché, a hamlet of the

commune of Mâcon.

The climate is oceanic, tempered by southern influences. Extremes are limited both by the natural barrier of the "Monts du Charollais" to the west, which partly protects the vines from wet influences, and by the beneficial influence of mild air currents coming from the south along the Rhône corridor from the first fine days. The average annual temperature is 11 °C. Summers are hot and sunny. Total annual rainfall does not exceed 800 millimetres, and rainfall is moderate during the vine's growing season.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

The village of Loché lies on a site occupied by the Romans, as attested by excavations carried out during recent construction work, which revealed the foundations of a large villa, the "villa Lopchiacum", which is undoubtedly the origin of the village's name. In the Middle Ages, Loché depended on the lordship of Vinzelles, the neighbouring village. The vine, established since the Roman occupation, prospered under the authority of the bishopric of Mâcon and the influence of the monks of the abbey of Cluny, 20 kilometres to the west. The presence in the village of cellars and wine stores dating back to the 17th century bears witness to the vitality of this vineyard over the centuries.

After the crises that struck the vineyard at the end of the 19th century, reconstitution was carried out exclusively with the chardonnay B variety, to the detriment of the gamay N variety that had previously dominated. The wines of "Loché" were then commonly sold under the name "Pouilly", the name of a neighbouring hamlet renowned for its white wine production. This usage reflects the recognised quality of the production of Loché. Until the beginning of the 20th century, the "wines of Pouilly" carried the renown of the "fine wine" vineyard of the "Sud Mâconnais".

Wishing to free themselves from this tutelage, the producers organised themselves and founded, in 1929, the "Cave coopérative des Grands crus blancs", then obtained recognition of the designation of origin "Pouilly-Loché", first by judgment in 1931, then as a controlled designation of origin by decree in 1940.

Production is shared between the cooperative system, historically dominant, and more recently dynamic private cellars. Producers highlight the diversity of natural situations through specific vinifications, emphasised by indicating the name of the "climat" or cadastral lieu-dit on the labels. Commercial dynamism is also reflected in a growing share of exports.

From the 1950s until the mid-1980s, the "Cave coopérative des Grands crus blancs" vinified almost all the volumes. It is still the largest operator, vinifying nearly 50 % of production. A cellar shop for private customers, opened in the 1960s, developed significantly from the 1980s, in parallel with the emphasis placed on indicating the "climat" on labels. Sales in bottle, and exports, really began to develop from that period. At the end of the 1990s, the arrival of a new generation of young growers contributed to the expansion of these practices. More and more producers vinify in their own cellars and are keen to individualise their cuvées and highlight the "climats".

The vines of "Pouilly-Loché" are trained according to the usages specific to the "Mâconnais", in particular arched-cane pruning known as "taille à queue du Mâconnais", which is predominant in the vineyard.

The area in production is about thirty hectares (one of the smallest areas for a protected designation of origin in Burgundy), for an average volume of 1,800 hectolitres, produced by about a dozen estates. More than 70 % of this production is sold in bottle.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product

Pale gold and crystal-clear in its youth, the wine may take on deeper tones with age. On the palate it has a broad and rich aromatic palette of citrus and other white-fleshed fruit such as grapefruit or

lemon, as well as apricot, often evolving with age towards more complex aromas of dried fruit and honeyed notes.

Wines benefiting from the term “premier cru” may be opulent and silky, round or livelier with a mineral note. They generally keep a fine balance that ensures their persistence on the finish.

3° – Causal interactions

The oceanic climate tempered by southern influences is expressed in a mildness characteristic of the south of the “Mâconnais” region. The wines of “Pouilly-Loché” display a particular typicity there, characterised by opulence and fruit on the palate, illustrating their “southern Burgundy” origin. Marked summer heat, sometimes lasting into the autumn, greatly benefits the vine by allowing advanced ripeness.

On this hillside facing the rising sun, at moderate altitude, the chardonnay B variety has found a choice site. The predominantly calcareous soils, which nevertheless retain a certain coolness, lead it to express elegance and minerality.

Although they cover a small area, the parcels precisely delimited for the harvesting of the grapes show a certain variety of soil and exposure conditions. The recognition of this diversity has encouraged producers to mention the name of the “climat” from which the grapes come on the labels, thus highlighting these nuances, which are fully expressed in the wines.

The efforts made by producers are constant, and know-how has been perpetuated to respect the original character of the wines expressed by the nature of the soils, both in viticultural practices and in the cellars. The “taille à queue du Mâconnais”, characteristic of this region, allows on the one hand a good distribution of nutrients within the vine plant and, on the other, protects the plants against spring frost.

This great white wine, produced with limited yields, expresses the quintessence of the chardonnay B variety. The individualisation of cuvées is the concern of all producers, who, proud of their best parcels, are keen to isolate each production and to show the names of the “climats” thus differentiated on their labels. This has enabled this protected designation of origin, long overshadowed by its big sister “Pouilly-Fuissé”, to become known thanks to the efforts of the young producers established since the end of the 1990s, who have developed export trade.

X. – Transitional measures

1° – Planting density

Vine parcels in place on 31 July 2009 with a planting density of between 6,000 and 8,000 plants per hectare continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the protected designation of origin until they are grubbed up.

2° – Pruning rules

Vine parcels in place before 31 August 1975 and pruned in the so-called “taille à queue du Mâconnais” may be pruned in such a way that, at the phenological stage corresponding to 11 or 12 leaves, each plant bears a maximum of 28 fruit-bearing shoots of the year, including 2 canes each bearing a maximum of 12 fruit-bearing shoots of the year.

3° – Harvesting method for wines eligible for the term premier cru

Parcels producing wines eligible for the term “premier cru” may be harvested mechanically for a period of 4 harvests from the date of approval of the present specification.

XI. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the protected designation of origin "Pouilly-Loché" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid protected designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) The name of a climat that may be associated with the term "premier cru" is placed immediately after the name of the protected designation of origin and printed in characters whose dimensions, both in height and in width, are not larger than those of the characters making up the name of the protected designation of origin.

b) The labelling of wines benefiting from the protected designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit "Vin de Bourgogne" or "Grand Vin de Bourgogne".

c) – The labelling of wines benefiting from the protected designation of origin may specify the smaller geographical unit, provided that:

- it is the name of a registered lieu-dit (cadastral locality);

- it appears on the harvest declaration;

- the name of the registered lieu-dit is not identical to that of a climat eligible for the term "premier cru", in order to avoid any problem of homonymy.

The name of the registered lieu-dit is printed in characters whose dimensions, both in height and in width, are not larger than half those of the characters making up the name of the protected designation of origin.

d) – Where the grape variety is indicated on the labelling, this indication does not appear in the same field of vision as the compulsory particulars and is printed in characters whose dimensions do not exceed 2 millimetres.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before circulation between authorised warehousekeepers and at the latest on 10 December of the year of harvest.

It indicates in particular:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied in particular by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

2. Declaration prior to transaction and collections

Every operator wishing to sell in bulk a wine benefiting from the protected designation of origin makes a transaction declaration for the lot concerned to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any collection.

This declaration, accompanied where applicable by a copy of the purchase contract, specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the identification of the containers;

- the identity of the buyer.

If collections are made for volumes smaller than those set out in the transaction declaration, the operator informs the approved control body in writing.

3. Declaration of release for consumption

Every operator declares to the approved control body each lot of wine intended to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

This declaration may also be drawn up for lots already packaged. It is made within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before release for consumption or before the lots concerned are dispatched from the operator's cellars.

It specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the lot number for wines already packaged;

- the identification of the containers for non-packaged wines.

However, making available to the approved control body the register referred to in Article D. 645-18 II of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code serves as the declaration of release for consumption, under the conditions set out in the control plan.

4. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to dispatch outside the national territory a non-packaged wine benefiting from the protected designation of origin declares it to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any dispatch.

5. Fallback declaration

Every operator carrying out a fallback of a wine benefiting from the protected designation of origin into a more general protected designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the

approved control body a monthly declaration at the latest on the 1st working day following the tenth day of each month.

This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the more general protected designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage;

- the state of the lot concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…).

The approved control body transmits without delay a copy of the monthly declaration to the approved control body for the more general protected designation of origin concerned.

The defence and management body transmits without delay to the defence and management body of the more general protected designation of origin concerned the list of operators who have made a monthly fallback declaration, together with a summary statement indicating:

- the more general protected designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage(s);

- the state of the lot(s) concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…).

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the protected designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the approved control body a monthly declaration within time limits set in the control plan. This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the volume downgraded;

- the vintage;

- the date of the downgrading.

7. Reworking of parcels

Before any development or any works liable to modify the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer (including any addition of exogenous soil) or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the protected designation of origin, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, the operator sends a declaration to the defence and management body at least four weeks before the planned start date of the works.

The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

8. Declaration of grubbing-up and planting

For parcels situated within the delimited parcel production area for wines eligible for the term “premier cru”, each operator declares to the defence and management body, before the end of the

current wine-growing year, the parcels grubbed up, the parcels planted and the provisional replanting plan.

II. – Keeping of registers

General plan of the storage and vinification places

Every vinifying operator keeps up to date and available for the approved control body a general plan of the storage and vinification places, allowing in particular the number, designation and capacity of the containers to be identified.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Location of operators within the immediate proximity area	Documentary check
A2 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	– Documentary check: up-to-date CVI parcel record; – Check in the field
A3 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of transitional measures, planting density, plant material)	– Documentary check; – Check in the field
A4 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	
Vat capacity	– Documentary check: general plan of the storage places; – On-site check
Ageing (temperature control and length of ageing)	– Documentary check: declaration of release for consumption or bottling register; – On-site check
State of upkeep of the cellar and equipment (hygiene)	On-site check
Protected storage place and storage conditions (T °C)	On-site check
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard	
Pruning	Check in the field
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
Cultivation and sanitary condition of the vine (sanitary condition of foliage and berries, upkeep of the soil, upkeep of the trellising)	Check in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	
Ripeness of the grapes	– Documentary check: records of ripeness monitoring; – Check in the field
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage	

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…)	– Documentary check: enrichment, acidification and de-acidification register; – On-site check
Stock accounts, analytical traceability	Documentary check: keeping of registers, analysis reports
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	– Documentary check (keeping the list up to date); – Check in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary check: check of declarations, monitoring of authorisations granted by the INAO services after their investigation of the operator's individual request
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary check: monitoring of destruction certificates
Claim declaration	– Documentary and on-site check: compliance with procedures and time limits, consistency with the harvest and production declarations; – Check of the release of products into circulation
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines (at transaction or collection)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Packaged wines (before or after preparation for release for consumption)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all lots
D – PRESENTATION OF THE PRODUCTS	
Labelling	On-site check

II. – References concerning the control structure

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Compliance with the present specification is checked on the basis of an approved control plan, by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence that has received delegation from the INAO.